Panel

From the cemeteries of ʻAyn al-Sira

Tulunid or Abbasid, mid-2nd to early 4th centuries AH / 9th-early 10th centuries CE

W: 70 cm; H: 20 cm

Inv. no. 11612



Carved and painted panel in the beveled style, featuring a central cordiform flanked by abstract foliate motifs within a rectangular frame composed of elongated oval cartouches with incised lines and small pierced holes. While rooted in Samarra Style C, it reveals a distinctly local sensibility: symmetrical curves and projecting pierced forms recall Ancient Egyptian depictions of radiating solar rays, reflecting continuity from Ancient Egypt through Greco-Roman, Coptic, and early Islamic periods. Similar motifs appear centuries later, notably on the Ottoman-era minbar in the mosque of Muhammad ʻAli (1848) in the Cairo Citadel. Incomplete and bearing substantial dents along its edges, this panel nevertheless preserves the dialogue between imperial style and local convention, and its material traces testify to its original architectural function and long history.

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